Alloy 0.6

Manual · free cymbal plugin from Collingwood Cymbals

Alloy plays my cymbal sample packs inside your music software. Every hit in a pack is recorded on a stereo ribbon pair and a mono spot mic at the same time. Alloy lets you blend the two and shape each mic on its own.

What you need

- Windows: a 64-bit VST3 host, such as Reaper, Cubase, Studio One, Ableton Live or FL Studio.
- Mac: macOS 10.15 or later, Apple silicon or Intel. Audio Unit for Logic Pro and GarageBand, VST3 for other hosts.
- A Collingwood cymbal pack, or your own WAV files.

Installing on Windows

1. Unzip `Alloy-0.6-Windows.zip`. You get a folder called `Alloy.vst3`.
2. Move it into your VST3 folder. The usual one is `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3`
3. Rescan plug-ins in your DAW and add Alloy to an instrument track.

Installing on Mac

1. Unzip `Alloy-0.6-Mac.zip`.
2. In Finder choose Go › Go to Folder... and paste `~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components`. Drag `Alloy.component` into that folder.
3. For VST3 hosts, also put `Alloy.vst3` in `~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3`
4. In Logic, make a Software Instrument track and choose AU Instruments › Collingwood › Alloy.

If Alloy isn't listed in Logic: Logic Pro › Settings › Plug-in Manager, select Alloy, then click Reset & Rescan Selection.

Loading sounds

A Collingwood pack

1. Unzip the pack and keep its folder together. It holds `Ribbon`, `Mono` and `alloy.txt`.
2. In Alloy press LOAD, or click the name window.
3. Open the cymbal's folder. Don't go into Ribbon or Mono. Click Load there.

Alloy loads both mics, all the velocity layers and round robins, and the measured mic timing in one go. You can also drag the cymbal's folder onto Alloy. CLEAR empties it.

Your own samples

Drag WAV files onto a pad. The top half of the pad is the ribbons, the bottom half is the mono mic. Drop several files to use them as round robins. Files with V1, V2 and so on in their names become velocity layers.

Playing it

Pad	Note	Pad	Note
TIP	C4 (60)	BELL	F4 (65)
SHOULDER	D4 (62)	CHOKE	G4 (67)
EDGE	E4 (64)	SWELL	A4 (69)

How hard you play picks the velocity layer. Each hit has several takes (round robins), set with the ROUND ROBIN switch.



The Alloy 0.6 panel

Handy to know

- Double-click a value window to type a number.
- Double-click a fader to reset it.
- Shift-drag for fine adjustment.
- Hold 0, 50/50 or 100 to hear that blend. Let go to go back.
- Alloy checks once a day for a newer version and tells you on its panel. It never sends anything about you.

> Alloy is free to use in your own music. The sample packs are plain 48 kHz 24-bit WAV files, so they also work in any DAW or sampler without Alloy.

The controls

Top and screen

LOAD / CLEAR	Load a cymbal folder, or empty Alloy.
UPDATE lamp	Lights in the header when a newer Alloy is out. Click it to open the download page.
BOTH / RIBBONS / MONO	Choose what the waveform shows. RIBBONS shows the left and right ribbons as two lanes.
Pads	One per articulation. VEL lights show the velocity layer that played, RR shows the take.

Ribbons (stereo pair) and Mono (spot mic)

LEVEL	Volume of that mic.
WIDTH (ribbons)	How wide the ribbon pair sounds. 100% is as recorded.
PAN (mono)	Where the mono mic sits left to right.
COMPRESS	Amount of compression. The GR lights show how much it is turning down.
PUNCH	Makes the start of each hit stronger or softer.
DRIVE	Adds tape-style grit.
AUTO GAIN	On DRIVE. On (the default), DRIVE stays at about the same level. Off, more DRIVE gets louder and hotter.
EQ	LOW CUT 20–600 Hz (fully left is off). LOW and HIGH shelves, and MID with MID FREQ from 300 Hz to 10 kHz, each ±12 dB.
PRE / POST	Puts that mic's EQ before or after its compressor.
COMP SLOW	A longer compressor release, 600 ms instead of 150 ms, for smoother cymbal tails.
SOLO	Hear only that mic.
Ø POL	Flips that mic's polarity.
SWAP L/R (ribbons)	Swaps the left and right ribbons.
ALIGN (mono)	Lines the mono mic up with the ribbons, using the timing measured for the pack.

Blend

0 · 50/50 · 100	Hold to hear the ribbons, an even mix, or the mono mic.
SET	Sets the blend to 50/50.
RIBBONS < > MONO	Blends between the two mic setups.
MONO DELAY	Delays the mono mic by up to a few milliseconds.
VELOCITY	How much your playing changes the sound.
DECAY	Shortens the ring-out. FULL is the natural length.
TUNE	Pitch, in semitones.
ROUND ROBIN	RANDOM (default) picks a take at random, never the same one twice running. CYCLE plays them in order. OFF always plays the first take.
CHOKE ON OFF	Turns choking of ringing hits on or off.

Bottom

TRIG	Lights when a note plays, and shows the note and velocity.
L / R meters	Output level.
OUTPUT	Overall volume.